

Signal | MVP Process Overview

Your goal is to create a system that automates sales outreach with email setup, lead management, message sequencing, and basic reporting—while keeping it simple enough to launch fast. We'll use AWS tools where possible (since you mentioned Route 53, SES, SNS, etc.) and add a Voiceflow chatbot to streamline user onboarding.

Step 1: Set Up the Email Infrastructure

You need a reliable email system for outreach. Here's how to do it with AWS:

1. **Set Up a Messaging Domain with Route 53**
 - Buy a cheap domain (e.g., youroutreach.com) via AWS Route 53.
 - Configure DNS records:
 - **SPF**: Allows your domain to send emails.
 - **DKIM**: Authenticates your emails to avoid spam flags.
 - **DMARC**: Sets policies for email authentication.
 - Takes ~1-2 hours if you follow AWS's Route 53 docs.
2. **Set Up Email Accounts with WorkMail**
 - Use AWS WorkMail to create an email organization (e.g., sales@youroutreach.com).
 - Cost: ~\$4/user/month—skip this if budget's tight and use SES directly.
3. **Warm Up the Email Account**
 - Use a tool like **Warmup Inbox** or manually send 20-50 emails/day to real contacts (e.g., friends) for 2 weeks.
 - Gradually increase volume to avoid spam filters.
4. **Set Up SES for Sending Emails**
 - Use Amazon SES (Simple Email Service) for sending bulk emails.
 - Request production access (takes ~24 hours) to move out of sandbox mode.
 - Cost: ~\$0.10/1,000 emails—super cheap.

Outcome: A warmed-up email system ready for outreach.

Step 2: Build the Core System

Now let's create the guts of your MVP—handling messages, leads, and CRM basics.

1. **Create a System for Messaging**
 - Use SES to send emails and **Amazon SNS** (Simple Notification Service) to track delivery status (e.g., sent, bounced).

- Build a simple Lambda function to:
 - Send emails based on a trigger (e.g., new lead added).
 - Handle replies by routing them to WorkMail or a basic inbox.
- 2. **Set Up CRM Configuration with DynamoDB**
 - Use **Amazon DynamoDB** (a NoSQL database) instead of a full CRM like HubSpot for now:
 - Tables: Contacts (leads), Companies, Tasks.
 - Fields: Name, Email, Company, Status (e.g., “Lead,” “Customer”).
 - Cost: Free tier covers ~25GB—plenty for an MVP.
- 3. **Understand KPIs and Tracking**
 - Track:
 - **Activity**: Emails sent, replies received.
 - **Sales Metrics**: Leads contacted, proposals sent, deals closed.
 - Use SNS to log events (e.g., email opened) and store them in DynamoDB.

Outcome: A lightweight system to send messages and manage leads.

Step 3: Lead Gen and Messaging

This is where you turn data into action.

1. **Lead Gen Process (ICP + Data)**
 - **Manual ICP**: Ask users to define their ICP in the Voiceflow chatbot (more on this later).
 - **Lead Download**: Let users upload a CSV (Name, Email, Company) via a simple UI.
 - Later, add scraping from LinkedIn or ZoomInfo (post-MVP).
2. **Write Message Templates**
 - Create 2-3 templates:
 - Cold email: “Hi [Name], I saw [Company] is focused on [Priority]. Let’s talk!”
 - Follow-up: “Hey [Name], just circling back—any interest?”
 - Store them in DynamoDB or a JSON file.
3. **Create Sequencing Setup**
 - Use Lambda to schedule emails:
 - Day 1: Send cold email.
 - Day 4: Send follow-up if no reply.
 - Add a filter: Skip if bounced or replied.

Outcome: Users can upload leads and start automated outreach.

Step 4: Build the User Interface (UI)

A simple UI keeps users engaged without overcomplicating things.

1. **UI for Importing Leads/Records**
 - Use **React** with a file upload component (e.g., react-dropzone).
 - Parse the CSV and send it to DynamoDB via an API Gateway + Lambda.
2. **UI for Tasks and Records**
 - A table showing leads (Name, Email, Status) and tasks (e.g., “Send Email”).
 - Add a button to trigger outreach manually.
3. **UI for Templates and Files**
 - A dropdown to pick a template and a text box to edit it.
 - Save changes to DynamoDB.
4. **Dashboard Screen for Analytics**
 - Use **Chart.js** to show:
 - Emails sent/day.
 - Open rate % (if SES tracking is set up).
 - Pull data from DynamoDB via Lambda.

Outcome: A basic frontend users can interact with.

Step 5: Add the Enably Chatbot with Voiceflow

Your idea for a chatbot to guide users is brilliant—let’s use **Voiceflow** to build it.

1. **Setup in Voiceflow**
 - Sign up for Voiceflow (free tier works).
 - Create a flow:
 - “Hi! Let’s set up your outreach. What’s your business name?”
 - “Who’s your target audience?”
 - “Upload your leads here” (link to UI).
2. **Integrate with AWS**
 - Use Voiceflow’s API block to call your Lambda functions (e.g., save ICP data to DynamoDB).
 - Guide users to SES setup steps with text or links.
3. **Output**
 - End with a summary: “Here’s your ICP and next steps—check your dashboard!”

Outcome: A friendly chatbot that walks users through setup.

Step 6: Reporting and Polish

Keep it lean but useful.

1. **Daily Reporting Process**

- Use SNS to send a daily email to users: “Sent 50 emails, 10 opened.”
- Or show it on the dashboard.

2. **Tracking Mechanism**

- SES provides basic tracking (sent, delivered, bounced).
- Add open tracking later with a pixel (post-MVP).

3. **Document the Process**

- Write a 1-page Google Doc with steps (e.g., “Set up SES, upload leads”).
- Share it with early users.

Outcome: Users get feedback and you have a guide to refine.

Tech Stack Recap

- **AWS:** Route 53 (domain), SES (email), SNS (notifications), DynamoDB (database), Lambda (logic), WorkMail (optional).
 - **Frontend:** React (UI), Chart.js (dashboard).
 - **Chatbot:** Voiceflow.
 - **Cost:** ~\$10-20/month with free tiers.
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How to Build It

1. **Day 1-2:** Set up Route 53, SES, and WorkMail. Start warming emails.
 2. **Day 3-4:** Build DynamoDB tables and Lambda functions for messaging.
 3. **Day 5-6:** Create the React UI (lead upload, tasks, dashboard).
 4. **Day 7-8:** Set up Voiceflow chatbot and connect it to AWS.
 5. **Day 9-10:** Test with 5-10 leads, tweak based on results.
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Tips to Stay on Track

- **Start Small:** Get SES sending one email first, then add sequences.
- **Use Tutorials:** AWS has great SES/Lambda guides—follow one.
- **Ask for Help:** If stuck, ping me or hit up AWS forums.

This MVP gets you a working outreach system in ~10 days. What do you think—ready to tackle Step 1? Need help with a specific part?